

Yongseok Choi 최용석

Senior Backend / Platform Engineer · Kotlin / JVM — 7 yrs engineering, 9 yrs total

cystmax@gmail.com +82 10 7701 3270 linkedin.com/in/choiyongseok1990 Seoul, Korea

I came to engineering from business operations — I ran HR at a shipping company for two years before I wrote production code, and I still design systems the way an operator would: around the handoffs, the messy parts, and the people who have to trust the output. At Baemin I own my team's infrastructure, and most recently I built and shipped the **agent pipeline that now runs our spec-to-QA process**, because everyone had adopted AI individually and no one owned whether the outputs connected. I believe the best engineering solves the problem without writing code.

EXPERIENCE

Apr 2023
— Present

Woowa Brothers — Baemin, Korea's largest food delivery platform

Backend Engineer · Team infrastructure owner

NOW Agent pipeline for the spec-to-QA process n8n + Claude · in production

- Diagnosed the real gap: PM, engineers, and QA had all adopted AI individually, but **no one owned whether the outputs connected** — every step was locally good and the process still leaked.
- Built the seam on our internal n8n with Claude skills per step: reads the PRD and the codebase together, emits a tech spec, a first-pass PRD review, and an explicit list of open questions; updates the checklist and moves the Jira ticket on feature push.
- Generates QA docs scoped to the **actual blast radius** of the code change; gaps found in QA count as code defects and feed back as improvement proposals. The tech spec self-updates at development end.
- An **observer holds full context across every document** and reports what is blocked, what is slipping, and what the code or QA left out.
- Most of my effort went into making tech specs legible to non-engineers — the artifact a PM actually reads, trusts, and acts on. I wired together tools we already had rather than building a new system.

Cross-domain infrastructure redesign Mar — Sep 2025

- Infra, backend, and frontend were tightly coupled; service dependencies blocked scaling and slowed incident response. Redesigned the architecture from the infra layer up — service separation, deploy restructuring, security review to lock the target.
- Overhauled the legacy auth filter (**50% less code and call paths**); handled cross-domain cookie, firewall, and permission issues; owned infra config and delivered a **zero-incident migration**.
- Result: **20% lower backend CPU/memory**, ₩500K/month infra savings. Presented on the Woowa tech blog and at company townhall.

Approval productivity measurement & dashboard Feb — Sep 2024

- No quantitative view of approver workload or efficiency, so productivity could not be compared and policy changes could not be validated with data.
- Normalized approval events into an aggregate data model and built the pipeline measuring cycle time, throughput, and bottlenecks. Designed the metrics around working-hour and policy conditions **drawn from my own HR domain experience** — the reason the numbers meant anything to the business.
- Published as a case in *Woowa Backend Engineering* (『우아한 백엔드 개발』) and on the Woowa tech blog.

Salesforce external integration & hardening Apr — Aug 2023

- Team's first external SaaS integration, with a hard requirement that outside failures never propagate into internal approval and contract transactions.
- Event-driven async architecture on internal CDC events, fully separating business logic from integration logic; per-event state, failure-typed retry pipelines, scheduler-based reprocessing with alerting.
- Internal processes stayed up through external outages. **Became the team's standard architecture** for external integrations and the base for later ones.

Team infrastructure ownership ongoing

- Introduced OpenTelemetry logging (unified request tracing across services); migrated EC2 → Kubernetes; Kafka connector setup and stabilization; SNS/SQS hardening (SDK upgrade, security config, cross-account wiring); Spring Boot 2.7 → 3.4 with the full JVM/Kotlin/Gradle upgrade.

Aug 2022
— Apr 2023

Yanolja Tech — R&D, Dodo Point loyalty platform

Backend Part Lead

- Operated the Dodo Point rewards service: **10M+ members, 100K+ daily transactions**.
- Built the dormant-member archival, sync, and purge pipeline — **10M archived, 10M synced, 4M purged**. Tuned Celery group parallelism and ignore-result; Python migration scripts with multiprocessing.

- Rewrote bulk message targeting extraction: **60s+ → under 8s** (Postgres). Security work across store, mobile, and landing channels: consent logic, dormant-member archival, purge, restore.

Nov 2021
– May 2022

DeepBrain AI — AI human / avatar platform

Full-stack Engineer

- **Shipped the AI Human all-in-one template solo** — design, DB, backend, frontend, deployment, and operations. Chatbot, STT, AI and speech models, and UI configured dynamically from admin settings. Released web, mobile, and tablet, verified across iOS and Safari.
- Scaled the relay server under heavy traffic: dual redundancy, DB replica set, disk and capacity changes, load balancing; redesigned local caching and master-DB operation so instances scale out cleanly.
- Cut preview render **from 30s to under 7s (4–5×)** for 400 characters by moving from video rendering to canvas image sequencing. Added gesture support to the web SDK with memory-efficient image loading and a reusable audio object for iOS.

Aug 2019
– Nov 2021

TmaxEnterprise

Full-stack Engineer, Team Lead

- Designed and built a customizable ERP HR system (Spring, JPA, Oracle, React) — HR, org, and evaluation modules from planning through backend. Dynamic-query compound assignment; slow-query remediation and index review; PL/SQL approval-line logic. **Rated top performer** for the employee-group feature enabling temporary employee status.
- MSA transition TF: Spring Cloud stack (RabbitMQ, API Gateway, Eureka, Config, Feign, Sleuth); event storming across HR, payroll, and accounting to define aggregates; hexagonal skeleton and test coverage.

Dec 2017
– Jul 2019

KMTC — Korea Marine Transport Co.

Human Resources

- Ran HR operations end to end — recruiting, payroll, personnel; introduced an IT recruiting platform and led the ERP evaluation-system improvement effort. *This is the operations experience my engineering still runs on.*
- Represented the company in the shipping-logistics blockchain consortium led by Samsung SDS and the Korea Customs Service; **won the internal idea award** for a container and vessel repair-record platform shared across repair vendors, carriers, and insurers.

SELECTED SIDE WORK

~2.5 years

Contract engineering — alongside full-time work

- Built an **AI pharmacy platform** and refactored a **gift commerce platform** — consumer healthcare and commerce. Both under client confidentiality; happy to talk through the architecture and tradeoffs in conversation.

7 months
pre-COVID

Airbnb — whole-unit rental, Sinchon, Seoul

Operated solo, end to end

- Listed the rooms of my three-room apartment individually and they barely booked. Looked at why: single-room supply in the area was saturated.
- **Changed the product.** Rented the whole unit and repositioned it around the one thing neighboring listings could not offer — no landlord downstairs, so parties and family gatherings were allowed — then furnished it to make that positioning real. Split pricing: ₩150,000/night for week-plus stays, ₩300,000/night for single nights bundled with services.
- **Superhost in one month.** Peak revenue over **₩4.5M/month against ₩150,000 monthly rent** (deposit-heavy Korean lease). Ended by COVID and lease expiry. I cleaned it myself every day.

SKILLS

LANGUAGES	Kotlin, Java, Python, JavaScript
FRAMEWORKS	Spring / Spring Boot, Spring Cloud, Node.js, Flask, React, Next.js
DATA	MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB
INFRA	AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, IAM), Kubernetes, Kafka, n8n
OBSERVABILITY	OpenTelemetry, Elasticsearch / Kibana / Logstash, Loki, Grafana
AI	Claude skills and agent workflows running in production

WRITING

BOOK	<i>Woowa Backend Engineering</i> (『우아한 백엔드 개발』) — approval productivity system, featured case
TECH BLOG	techblog.woowahan.com/24066 — cross-domain infrastructure redesign · /20029 — approval productivity

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

EDUCATION	Yonsei University — B.A., Economics
LANGUAGES	Korean (native) · English (fluent, TOEIC 985)